Measuring Speed

The unit of measure used to measure speed depends on the object being measured. Here are some of the different units used to measure speed

Units of measure for speed		
Unit	symbol	Value of this unit in km/h
Kilometres travelled in one hour.	Km/h	**1 km/h =1 km/h**
Meters travelled in 1 second	m/s	**3.6km/h=1 m/s**
Mach One speed of sound unit. Each Mach unit is equal to the speed of sound.	Mach	**1,235 km/h=1 Mach**
One speed of light unit. This is how fast light travels in an hour	C	**1,079,252,848.8 km/h = 1 C**

Look at the list of moving objects below and choose the most suitable unit to measure their speed. Then try and do the conversion.

Object	Average speed km/h	Most suitable unit	Can you work out how to convert this to the unit you chose? Try it.
Bullet	1,200		
North American X 15 jet plane	7,258		
Space shuttle re-entering the Earth's atmosphere	30,000		
Bus	90		
A snail crawling	0.02		